

Hariharan Vijay Iswaran

Security Engineer | Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with an M.S. in Cybersecurity (GPA 3.90) and hands-on experience in security monitoring, SIEM, incident response, vulnerability management, IAM, endpoint security, network security, Linux, Windows, and cloud environments. Experienced in investigating security events using Elastic SIEM, Kibana, KQL, Python, Windows Event Logs, DNS, SSL/TLS, and NetFlow telemetry. Skilled in log analysis, threat detection, security automation, and documentation.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations: SIEM, Security Event Investigation, Vulnerability Management, Endpoint Security

Detection & Analytics: Elastic SIEM, Kibana, KQL, Log Correlation, Log Analysis, Threat Detection

Systems & Infrastructure: Linux, Windows, Active Directory, IAM, SSO, System Hardening

Security Tools: Nmap, Nessus, Wireshark, Metasploit, Netcat, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, SQLMap

EDUCATION

M.S. Cybersecurity - GPA: 3.90 - University of North Carolina at Charlotte — Charlotte, NC

Aug 2020 - May 2026

B.Tech Information Technology - GPA: 3.5 | SRM Institute of Science and Technology — India

Sept 2020 - May 2024

Certifications: eJPTv2 | AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (SAA-C03) | **OSCP** — In Progress

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Linux Specialist | University of North Carolina at Charlotte

Oct 2025 – May 2026

- **Endpoint Security & Vulnerability Management:** 100+ workstations required remediation from EOL Linux versions; led migration, audited system records, and identified unmanaged endpoints; improved endpoint security, configuration compliance, and vulnerability posture.
- **IAM & Asset Management:** Inconsistent access provisioning and unmanaged assets created security exposure; managed user/admin groups in Grouper and identified, securely wiped, and decommissioned 25+ unused workstations; strengthened access control and reduced unmanaged endpoint exposure.
- **Incident Response & Support:** Investigated and escalated OS, network, and configuration issues; provided Tier 1/2 support, resolved 15+ tickets weekly, documented findings, and communicated resolutions; improved operational response.
- **Log-Based Troubleshooting:** Linux system issues, including graphical errors, network and boot failures, required root-cause identification; accessed and analyzed system logs to diagnose and resolve issues; reduced repeat incidents through accurate diagnosis.
- **Security Automation:** Failed package installations threatened reliable workstation deployment; monitored automated deployment jobs, diagnosed deployment failures, and remediated package issues; maintained a repeatable secure-imaging pipeline.

Graduate Instructional Assistant | University of North Carolina at Charlotte

Jan 2025 – May 2025

- **Technical Troubleshooting:** 25 students weekly encountered Python and cryptography issues; diagnosed problems and developed solution keys; improved technical support, grading consistency, and feedback turnaround.
- **Confidentiality & Documentation:** Academic records required controlled handling; managed Canvas/Gradescope operations and exam proctoring; maintained accurate documentation and confidentiality of sensitive records.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Threat Detection & Log Analysis | Python, Elastic SIEM, Kibana, KQL

Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

- **Endpoint Incident Investigation:** A simulated USB policy violation required endpoint identification; correlated Windows Event Logs for USB activity; identified the violating workstation and documented the security finding.
- **Authentication Threat Detection:** Suspected Pass-the-Hash activity required investigation; analyzed Kerberos/NTLM authentication telemetry and suspicious-account activity; identified the compromised host and attack source.
- **Security Monitoring & Threat Hunting:** Suspected compromised scanner credentials affected multiple systems; developed KQL queries to correlate service logs and affected hosts; identified 14 affected machines and isolated attack-launch hosts.
- **Threat Intelligence & DNS Analysis:** DNS logs lacked threat context; built a Python enrichment pipeline using domain-frequency scoring and Top 1M comparison; identified a suspected DGA-based command-and-control domain.
- **SSL/TLS & Network Investigation:** Suspicious certificates and external traffic required security analysis; performed Kibana certificate analysis and Python IP/ASN enrichment in Elastic SIEM; identified six suspicious source IPs and likely 50+ MB data exfiltration with 30+ beaconing connections.